

Beef and Broccoli

By Sam Sifton



Gentl and Hyers for The New York Times. Food stylist: Maggie Ruggiero. Prop stylist: Rebecca Bartoshesky.

Total Time 45 minutes

Rating ★★★★★ (3,858)

Here is a streamlined, powerfully flavorful recipe for a delivery-food standby: velvety wok-fried beef in a oyster-soy sauce, served in a forest of green. “It’s diaspora food,” the chef Jonathan Wu told me, describing the cooking of Chinese immigrants to the United States and a dish that is almost unknown in China but beloved in America. The recipe is a version of the one Wu’s mother made for dinner when he was growing up outside Hartford, Conn., with a little chile-garlic paste added for zip and, thanks to the Brooklyn chef Dale Talde, a pat of butter swirled into the sauce at the end. This provides a plush gloss that is far better than the traditional cornstarch slurry. It is midweek family cooking at its best.

INGREDIENTS

Yield: 4 servings

- ⅓ cup Shaoxing rice wine, dry sherry or sake
- 3 tablespoons plus 2 teaspoons soy sauce
- 1 tablespoon cornstarch
- 1 pound beef — chuck or rib steak — sliced thin against the grain
- ¼ cup oyster sauce

PREPARATION

Step 1

In a large bowl, whisk together the wine, 2 tablespoons of the soy sauce and the cornstarch. Add the beef to the bowl, and toss to combine, then cover the bowl, and set aside for 20 minutes or so.

Step 2

To make the sauce, combine in a small bowl the remaining soy sauce, the oyster sauce and the chile-garlic sauce, and mix to combine, then add a tablespoon of water and mix again. Set aside.

Step 3

½ tablespoon chile-garlic sauce, or to taste

½ cup plus 1 tablespoon neutral oil, like canola, grapeseed or peanut

1 pound broccoli, the head cut into florets and the stems peeled and cut into planks

2 tablespoons unsalted butter

Heat the ½ cup of oil in a wok set over high heat. When the oil is hot and shimmering, add about half the beef to the wok, and stir-fry until it is browned and crisp and barely cooked through, about 2 minutes. Transfer to a bowl or plate, and set aside. Then repeat with remaining beef.

Step 4

Pour off the oil in the wok, wipe it out with a towel and return it to the stove over high heat. Add the remaining tablespoon oil, and swirl it around and heat it until it is smoking. Add the broccoli and cook, tossing and stirring frequently, until lightly charred in spots, about 2 minutes.

Step 5

Add 2 tablespoons water to the wok, and toss and stir the broccoli in the steam for an additional 2 minutes, then return beef to the wok, followed by the sauce. Cook, stirring and tossing frequently, for 30 seconds or so, then add the butter, and stir and toss again for 30 seconds more. Serve immediately, with rice.

Private Notes

Leave a Private Comment on this recipe and see it here.